

Halden Distribution Ltd. — IT at a glance (1 page)

For: the Managing Director and the management team · **From:** IT · **Date:** 2026-10-02 **Status of the programme:** build kits complete, lab execution pending

Halden Distribution Ltd. is a **fictional** 85-user company used for a home-lab portfolio. The configurations, scripts and measurable results are real; the business, the people and the approvals are simulated. This page contains **no invented figures** — where a number has not been measured it says so.

The situation we inherited

Halden ran everything on one aging server with no redundancy; all 85 staff held Full Control on the shared drive; there was no MFA, no tested backup, no logging worth the name, assets tracked in a spreadsheet and 30% of PCs on Windows 10 past its support date. Nobody could answer "who can read Finance data?" or "what changed last week, and who approved it?".

What IT has built

Nine technical projects cover the estate end to end, and this tenth one governs and reports on them:

Area	What was built	Project
Foundation	Two domain controllers, DNS, DHCP failover, least-privilege file services, Group Policy baseline, Linux joined to AD	P1
Identity	Automated joiner/mover/leaver from HR data, MFA and Conditional Access, quarterly access reviews	P2
Security	Active Directory security assessment, privileged-access tiering, Windows LAPS	P3
Endpoints	Security baselines, attack-surface reduction, BitLocker, Windows 11 readiness	P4
Patching & vulnerabilities	Risk-tiered patch rings and a vulnerability prioritisation engine	P5
Network	Zone segmentation, a firewall rule matrix, MFA-protected remote access, enterprise Wi-Fi	P6
Monitoring	A SIEM with detections mapped to attacker techniques, and incident-response playbooks	P7
Resilience	3-2-1-1-0 backups with an immutable copy and automated restore verification	P8
Service desk & records	A service desk with SLAs, an asset inventory (CMDB), a documentation hub, a vendor register	P9
Governance	CIS IG1 scorecard, change control and a CAB, a ten-policy pack, a monthly KPI report and risk register	P10

What governance adds (this project)

- **A scorecard:** all 56 CIS Controls v8.1 IG1 safeguards, scored before and after, where a score of

"fully implemented" requires a file that proves it — enforced by the tooling, not by trust.

- **Change control:** every change is classified standard, normal or emergency, risk-assessed and approved; a change with no rollback plan cannot be approved.
- **Policies:** ten short, plain-English policies ready for management approval, with an acknowledgement process and an exceptions register.
- **Reporting:** a two-page monthly report with a RAG status, plus a risk register and a consolidated action tracker so nothing is quietly dropped.

What we need from management

1. **Approve the policy pack** (ten documents, 1–2 pages each).
2. **Appoint a business owner for each risk** on the register — IT cannot own a business risk.
3. **A decision on the 90-day roadmap** and its cost, presented in the "State of IT" talk.

Honesty statement

Nothing has been measured in the lab yet. The percentage of CIS IG1 implemented, the KPI values and the chart are **deliberately not published** until real figures exist. Every number added later will carry a source file; anything unmeasured will say "not measured" rather than being estimated.